

ÜMIT

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Figure 1: ÜMIT

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1 Overview

ÜMIT is a 2D/3D animated short film created by students at the Savannah College of Art and Design (SCAD). Set in the 15th-century Kazakh Kingdom—present-day Kazakhstan—the story follows a young astronomer named Ümit, who is determined to bring back the long-lost Sun to her village, which has been trapped in darkness

for centuries. As hope fades and life becomes increasingly difficult, Ümit clings to hope and builds a device that could reunite her people with the light.

Inspired by nomadic Central Asian cultures, the Timurid Renaissance, Tengri music, and coming-of-age tales, ÜMIT is a heartfelt tribute to resilience, astronomy, and cultural identity. Through its story and setting, the film hopes to shed light on Central Asian narratives—one among many cultures around the world often overlooked in global media and animation.